A Warrior's Oath

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/32172463.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra, Lonnie (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
glimmadora week 2021, Glimmadora week, Glimmadora - Freeform, Glimmadora Week Day 1, Mild Blood, Assassins, AU, Fantasy AU, Slight crossover with Dragon Prince, you'll see - Freeform

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of Glimmadora Week 2021

Stats:
Published: 2021-06-25 Words: 1,378 Chapters: 1/1

A Warrior's Oath

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/32172463.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra, Lonnie (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
glimmadora week 2021, Glimmadora week, Glimmadora - Freeform, Glimmadora Week Day 1, Mild Blood, Assassins, AU, Fantasy AU, Slight crossover with Dragon Prince, you'll see - Freeform

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of Glimmadora Week 2021

Stats:
Published: 2021-06-25 Words: 1,378 Chapters: 1/1

A Warrior's Oath

by TheShortestManOnEarth

Summary

Glimmadora Week 2021 Day 1: Fantasy AU/Kisses Prompt.

Adora is tasked with an important mission. The success of the mission means everything. Failure isn't an option. Not when you've pledged yourself to an oath.

Notes

Hi All,

This is coming a bit late (Glimmadora Week was originally May 15th-21st). But I had classes through the end of May and I've been slowly catching up on my prompts since then.

This fic was inspired by the beginning of the show "The Dragon Prince" so if you've seen it, this may make more sense. If not, just know the idea is that Adora is an assassin who has been ordered to kill Angella.

I flagged this with "Graphic Depictions of Violence" to be safe but the actual violence is pretty low. Let me know if something needs to be tagged and I'll add it.

My other multi-chapter works will be updated soon.

Thanks for reading! See you at the next prompt.

Finding the right words to say used to be easy. When times were simpler. Or when all Glimmer had to do was look at Adora and the blonde would pull them both into a confusing tangled mess of kisses.

At first, Adora's kisses were slow, hesitant, and almost comically measured. Adora was an organized person through and through. Glimmer learned quickly that if they wanted to spend any amount of time together, she had to plan for it. If she wanted to talk to Adora, it was always clear that the blonde didn't say anything without overthinking it. The gears behind her eyes were endlessly turning. It was a wonder Adora hadn't overworked her thoughts to where they'd crash into each other and Glimmer assumed that was exactly what happened when Adora first initiated kissing.

Glimmer had assumed that Adora didn't know what kissing was, let alone having kissed anyone. The Horde Kingdom, a realm known for its brutal training of its inhabitants as disposable soldiers, raised Adora to be a warrior and nothing else.

When they'd settled down after a particularly grueling fight, armor stained with blood, sweat, and fear, logic was the last thing on the warrior's mind. Glimmer was used to being the impulsive one. She'd sneak out in the middle of the night to go scouting, only to find that Adora had managed to follow. The warrior had a sixth sense where Glimmer's recklessness was concerned. Adora seemed to know exactly where to be even if was the middle of the night. If she were honest, she'd admit she didn't sleep half as much as she should. But she was nothing if not vigilant and stuck to her routines.

Adora had come to Bright Moon the first time in the middle of the night. The red insignia on her surcoat painted her as the enemy Glimmer had seen her whole life. Maybe night was their time of day. The thought brought a bittersweet smile to the future Queen's face. The warrior's armor had given her away as she charged through the brush and when Glimmer had jumped out, the weight of the metal had sent them both tumbling down.

Their eyes had locked and somehow Adora's nerve left her. It was enough for Glimmer to kick the blonde and flick a blade to the blonde's throat to take the upper hand. Everyone had said there were assassins coming. Glimmer didn't want to believe it. Yet, here was one. A Horde killer no less.

"Do it." Adora's blue eyes were almost as cold a gray as the steel she wore in the light of the night. Glimmer gripped her blade tighter but didn't move. "What are you waiting for?"

Glimmer wasn't sure herself. What *was* she waiting for? No one was going to tell her to kill this soldier, this enemy, and no one was going to bloody their hands in her stead now. She lifted her blade to strike, and the blonde's eyes widened. Maybe it was fear. Maybe it was the fact that she was about to die, and no one would be there to remember her botched assassination. But Adora's eyes went to the sparkles in Glimmer's hair.

"Beautiful…" The word was barely out before Glimmer's hand stalled, the blade just centimeters from burying itself in the warrior's chest.

"What?"

Adora must not have realized what she'd said because she then blinked, looking down at the blade. The weapon had slipped a little in Glimmer's hand. The blonde then pushed up, disarming the other girl. It was a deftly delt motion with all the clumsiness of a girl who wanted to take her words with her to the grave.

"Wait." To the surprise of both, Adora did. With one word Glimmer had broken the wall Adora had erected to keep emotions at bay. "You don't want to do this."

The warrior tilted her head to the side. "I don't?"

"I don't think you do." Glimmer said. Every instinct in her body was telling her to defend and to take the blade from the blonde. But she didn't. Both had decided to take a chance in the hopes

that somehow the simple humanity they shared would be enough to stop tragedy from unfolding.

But their world wasn't that simple. Falling in love and kissing was a short-lived fantasy. One grown out of purehearted dreams.

Adora had almost forgotten that she was part of a larger plot of the Horde to bring Bright Moon down. Or that she'd lost touch with her squad not too long ago. It wasn't until Adora felt a chill come over her one night. She had been patrolling as she often did when she felt restless.

Her rounds took her to the parapets of Bright Moon Castle. The night seemed quiet. She sighed and made to return to the stairs when she found herself face to face with one of her comrades.

"Lonnie." Adora whispered. Her eyes widened. "Wait, if you're here then… No…" The blonde made a dash for the stairs. Lonnie didn't stop her.

"You're too late, Adora." The words didn't reach the warrior before she was tearing through the halls. As she reached the Queen's room with its door open, yet unbroken, Adora felt another chill run through her body.

A small push was all it took to open the doors the rest of the way. There in the center of the room was Catra, her sword drawn and ready to do what Adora couldn't not too long ago. Adora didn't wait this time. She moved in between Glimmer and the sword, her own blade barely parrying the attack. The room rang with the loud clanging of metal and the hiss Adora let loose when her sloppy guard failed to hold against Catra's assault. She clutched at her shoulder and finally met two mismatched eyes.

"I was wondering if you could pull this off." Catra seethed. "I told myself that you were here, biding your time until we could all strike." She let loose a hollow laugh. "I saved you. If the Horde found out that you couldn't finish this-when you swore an *oath*."

Adora's face drained of color as her eyes went to the floor. There was no mistaking the body there. "I don't want this."

Shouts could be heard down the hall as the guards closed in on the scene. Adora knew she couldn't go back to the Horde. Yet, she knew that she was guilty of being part of the reason Queen Angella was now dead. "Don't want this? You're a Horde killer. This is who you are. This is what you pledged to, Adora. You don't get to choose."

"Yes, she does." Glimmer stepped forward, placing herself between the two. "She never wanted this. Right?"

Adora remembered how she'd surrendered to the emotions that freed her mind from the growing fear that one day her actions, or lack thereof, would catch up with her. She'd taken a blow not unlike this one and suddenly she couldn't take the chance that she might not be able to tell Glimmer just how incredible she was. How the lowly Horde killer, the enemy assassin had somehow let her guard down entirely. She had promised to kill someone she'd barely known.

The guards burst in and Catra quickly retreated to the window. Adora met the mismatched eyes for a moment before they looked away. Without any words the former assassin knew she'd failed officially.

"Adora?" Glimmer's voice was a salve to a burning wound that no one, not even the best healers could cure. The warrior looked down at her wrist where the oath band was turning black, sinking into her skin.

The blonde tried to look away. She couldn't face Glimmer's disappointment or the blame. "We'll figure this out. Together." Adora bit her lip, daring to face the Princess. Their foreheads touched and the kiss that followed was gentle, fearful, but more of a vow than the words Adora had spoken over a week ago.

The band burned bright yellow and then slowly faded to leave a faint red mark. “Together.” Adora agreed. Fighting wouldn’t be simple. It never was. But the stand to fight by Glimmer’s side was worth the battles lost and won.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!